Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From a report by a US Senate Subcommittee investigating the refugee crisis in South Vietnam, 1968.
Our heavy reliance on search-and-destroy operations and chemical defoliants has created hundreds of thousands of refugees. When we burn villages suspected of aiding the Vietcong and spray crops with Agent Orange, we are not winning the hearts and minds of the peasants. Instead, we are driving them directly into the arms of the enemy. The destruction of their ancestral lands has caused deep hatred of the US military.

Source C

Source C: From an interview with a Vietcong veteran, recalling the impact of US bombing and search-and-destroy missions, 1985.
The Americans had helicopters and napalm, but they did not know who the enemy was. When they came to our villages, they treated everyone as Vietcong. They burned our huts and killed our livestock. This made even the quietest peasants want to fight them. The American soldiers were terrified of our booby traps and snipers, so they responded with massive firepower that destroyed everything, making the people hate them even more.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
US tactics in Vietnam were self-defeating. The search-and-destroy missions and the widespread use of chemical defoliants like Agent Orange and napalm devastated the countryside. By destroying the homes and crops of the South Vietnamese peasants, these tactics alienated the civilian population and drove them to support the Vietcong, making a US victory impossible.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
US tactics were militarily necessary to counter Vietcong guerrilla warfare. Search-and-destroy missions successfully killed large numbers of enemy fighters and disrupted their supply bases in the jungle. Without these aggressive operations, the Vietcong would have easily overrun South Vietnam. The tactics prevented a communist victory and gave the South Vietnamese government time to build its own forces.

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